

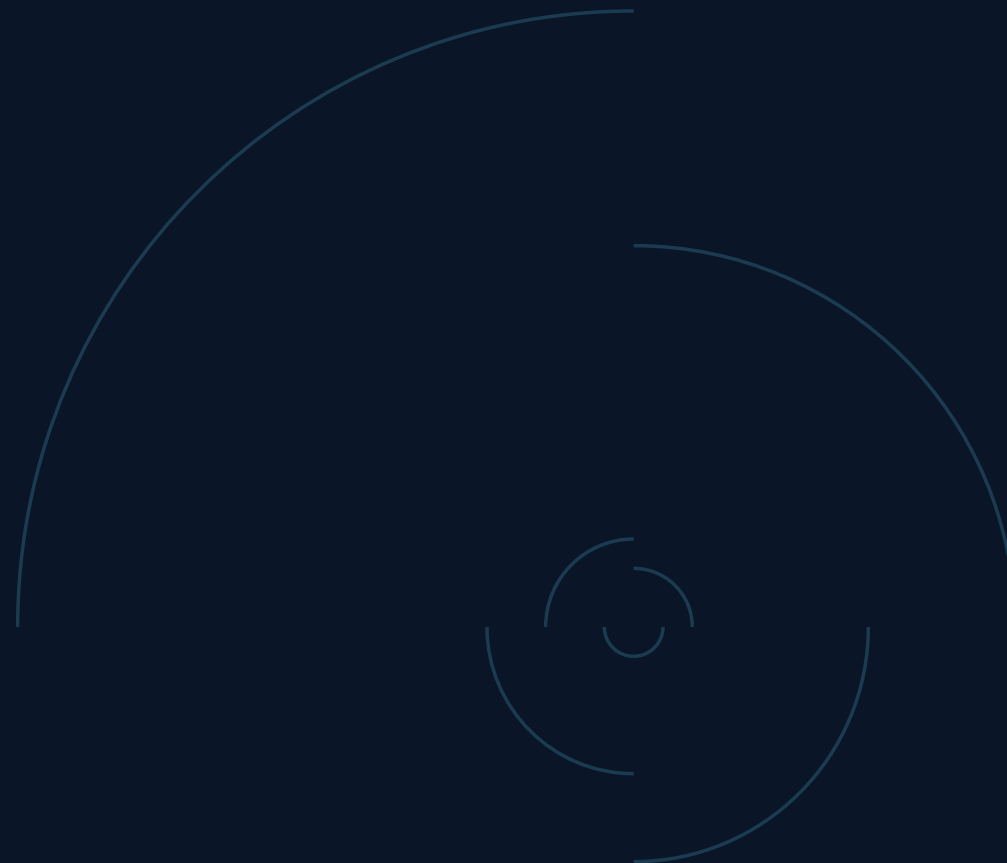
THE SURF SEQUENCE®

Inclusive Coaching

One Method. Every Surfer.

COACH TRAINING MODULE — VERSION 1.0 — MARCH 2026

Evolve through play



Preserve the sequence. Adapt the delivery.

INCLUSION IS NOT

Lowering standards.

The sequence stays ordered.

INCLUSION IS

The professional ability to teach the same method to different humans.

What changes is how the coach opens the door.

7 Non-Negotiable Principles

1

Sequence before
improvisation

2

Dignity before pressure

3

Observation before
judgment

4

Challenge with dose

5

Tool must fit the student

6

Access before performance

7

Every body surfs

The Inclusive Coach

Not merely kind. Observant. Precise. Regulated. Adaptive.

Observes before judging

Explains without overload

Adapts the route, not the standard

Corrects action, not identity

Distinguishes technical vs emotional blocks

Teaches across languages

Children (under 12)

- One main idea at a time
- More demonstration, less theory
- Use games deliberately — not as chaos
- Immediate and specific feedback
- Expectations matched to maturity

Evolve through play — games are structured, not chaotic.

Teenagers (12–17)

- **Challenge ability, not identity**
Treat them as capable, not as children
- **Peer dynamics matter**
Group composition affects confidence
- **Channel competitive energy**
Missions and challenges → progression
- **Private correction, public recognition**
Correct quietly. Recognize publicly.

Adults

- Explain purpose when it builds trust
- Respect processing time
- Use adult language and direct correction
- Normalize error as progression
- Acknowledge life context — efficiency + respect

Barriers are often mental as much as physical.

Older Adults (55+)

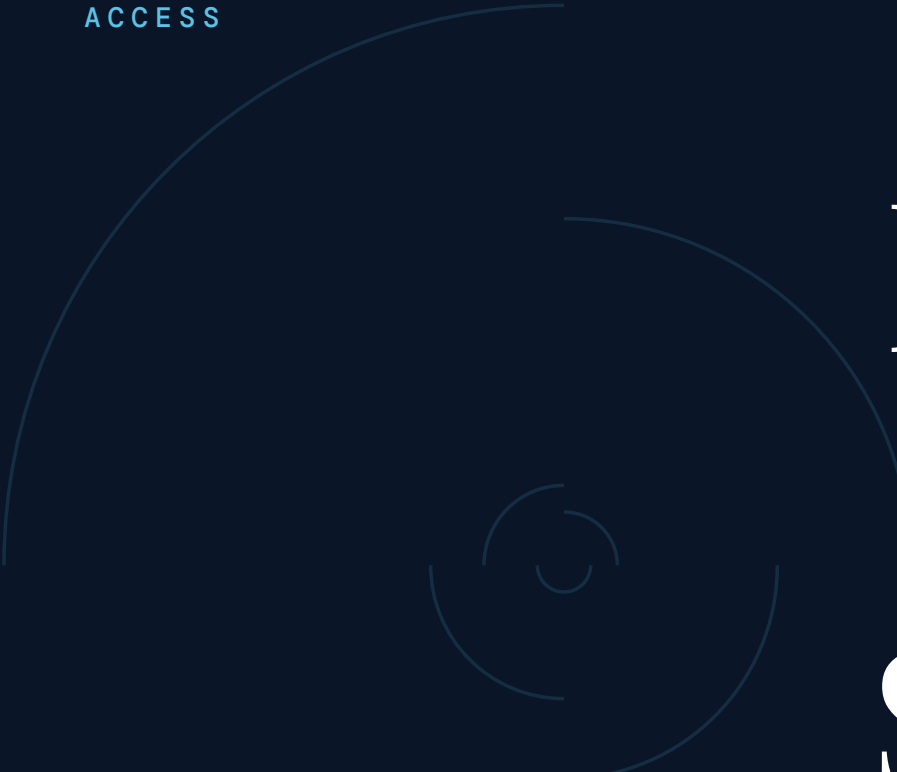
- **Generous equipment**
8'–9'+ boards with abundant volume
- **Reduce explosive demands**
Modify paddling intensity, allow alternative pop-up
- **Longer warm-ups, shorter water time**
Protect joints, manage fatigue
- **Celebrate consistency over intensity**
A controlled ride > an explosive attempt
- **Assist entry and exit**
Help with boards, rocks, water navigation

Students with Fear

Fear is not weakness. It is information.

- Start smaller — controlled whitewater, closer coach
- Create ONE small win before adding challenge
- “I am here. I can see you. You are safe.”
- Allow opt-out without shame

Reduce complexity before reducing dignity. Never shame fear.



ACCESS

EVERY BODY SURFS.

Body size, age, physical condition, and appearance are never reasons to exclude. They are variables the coach adapts to.

Equipment Adaptation by Weight

WEIGHT	BOARD	TYPE
20–35 kg	6'0"–6'6"	Softboard
35–50 kg	6'6"–7'0"	Softboard / mini mal
50–65 kg	7'0"–7'6"	Softboard / funboard
65–80 kg	7'6"–8'0"	Funboard / mini mal
80–95 kg	8'0"–8'6"	Mini mal / longboard
95+ kg	8'6"–9'0"	Longboard / high-vol soft

The equipment adapts to the student, not the student to the equipment.

Diagnostic Rule

If the student fails the takeoff, check in this order:



Many apparent technique problems are actually equipment decisions.

4 Learning Channels

VISUAL

See clean form

Demonstrate, landmarks,
before/after

KINESTHETIC

Feel body position

Dry-land reps, assisted setup

VERBAL

Logic and criteria

Explain purpose, order, cues

RELATIONAL

Trust and safety

Regulate tone, create small
wins

When one channel doesn't work, switch.

Demonstrate → Guide physically → Explain why → Regulate the emotional space

TSS METHOD: EXPLAIN → DEMONSTRATE → PARTICIPATE → FEEDBACK

Language Is Never a Reason to Exclude

- Demonstration first — the body is universal language
- Consistent gesture vocabulary (point, stop, thumbs)
- 5–10 essential words in the student's language
- Draw in the sand — use the board as a prop
- Peer translation when available

ESSENTIAL PHRASES:

Go / Stop / Stand / Paddle / Turn / Good / Again / Careful / Danger

Emotional Regulation Rules

IF FEAR IS HIGH

→ Reduce complexity before reducing dignity

IF FRUSTRATION RISES

→ Remove variables, recover one small success

IF CONFIDENCE INFLATED

→ Return to criteria and execution

IF STUDENT BLOCKS

→ Switch channel: demo, drill, pause, simpler mission

Inclusive Session Architecture

1 ENTRY

Read energy, experience, confidence, language

2 MISSION

One clear, achievable objective

3 DEMO

Show simply. Use multiple channels.

4 PROGRESSION

Stable → dynamic, basic → specific

5 FEEDBACK

Short, actionable, one correction at a time

6 CLOSURE

Summarize gain + next step

Design for the student who needs the most support. Everyone else still progresses.

DO vs DON'T

DO

- ✓ "Your feet were too narrow"
- ✓ Adapt the board to the student
- ✓ Ask what works for them
- ✓ Create one win first
- ✓ Switch channels when stuck

DON'T

- ✗ "You're bad at this"
- ✗ Force a small board on a big body
- ✗ Assume all students learn the same
- ✗ Shame fear or slow progress
- ✗ Talk more when they don't understand

Inclusive Coach Certification

STAGE 1

Manual study

Quiz / discussion

STAGE 2

Dry-land practice

Practical demos

STAGE 3

Live session

Observed coaching

STAGE 4

Renewal

Video audit / review

One method.
Every surfer.
No exceptions.

